

# Week 8: Mini-Project — Build Your Developer Portfolio Repo

---

## Goal

Create a public GitHub repository called **dev-portfolio** that will house every project you build for the rest of the bootcamp. By the end of this project, you'll have:

- A live, public repo on your GitHub profile
- A professional **README.md** introducing yourself
- A working **.gitignore**
- A feature branch (**add-profile**) with a follow-up commit
- A merged Pull Request showing the feature branch landing into **main**

This is your first real public-facing piece of work as a developer. Take it seriously — recruiters and future collaborators will see it.

---

## Requirements Checklist

- Local repo initialised: **dev-portfolio/**
  - **README.md** written using proper Markdown (headings, list, links)
  - **.gitignore** covering at minimum: **.env**, **node\_modules/**, **\*.log**, **.DS\_Store**
  - Feature branch named **add-profile**
  - **profile.md** file added on the feature branch
  - Both **main** and **add-profile** pushed to GitHub
  - Pull Request opened on GitHub merging **add-profile** → **main**
  - PR merged and feature branch deleted (locally and on GitHub)
  - Final repo has at least 3 commits in **main**
- 

## Setup

```
# Create and enter the project folder
mkdir dev-portfolio
cd dev-portfolio

# Initialise Git
git init
```

## Step 1: Build the Initial Files on main

Create three files: `README.md`, `.gitignore`, and a placeholder index.

### README.md template

```
# Your Name – Software Engineering Portfolio

Welcome! This is the home of every project I build during the UpliftHub Bootcamp and
beyond.

## About Me

I'm based in Bauchi and learning software engineering through the UpliftHub Bootcamp. My
current track is choose later.

## Bootcamp Projects

| Week | Project | Description |
|-----|-----|-----|
| 6 | BauchiUtils | A 15-function utility library |
| 7 | Student Records | An in-memory CRUD database |
| 8 | This portfolio | Set up and configured this repo |

## How to Reach Me

- GitHub: [your-username](https://github.com/your-username)
- Email: your.email@example.com
```

Replace placeholders with your actual info. Don't put your phone number or home address — this is public.

### .gitignore template

```
# Dependencies
node_modules/

# Secrets
.env
.env.local

# Logs
*.log

# OS
.DS_Store
Thumbs.db

# Editor
.vscode/
.idea/
```

## Commit and push

```
# Stage everything
git add README.md .gitignore

# First commit
git commit -m "Initial commit: portfolio README and gitignore"

# Add a second small commit so the history isn't just one commit
echo "# Welcome" > index.md
git add index.md
git commit -m "Add placeholder index page"

# Verify the history
git log --oneline
# Should show 2 commits
```

## Step 2: Connect to GitHub

1. Go to [github.com](https://github.com) → click “+” in the top right → “New repository”
2. Name: **dev-portfolio**
3. Description: “My software engineering portfolio”
4. Visibility: **Public**
5. **DO NOT tick** “Initialize this repository with a README”
6. Click “Create repository”

7. Copy the URL it shows (looks like <https://github.com/yourname/dev-portfolio.git>)

Back in your terminal:

```
# Connect local repo to GitHub
git remote add origin https://github.com/your-username/dev-portfolio.git

# Make sure your branch is named main
git branch -M main

# First push, set upstream for next time
git push -u origin main
```

Refresh your GitHub repo page — both files should be there.

---

## Step 3: Add a Profile Page on a Feature Branch

```
# Branch off main
git checkout -b add-profile

# Create the profile file
cat > profile.md << 'EOF'
# About the Author

## Background

I'm a learner in the UpliftHub Bootcamp, based in Bauchi. Before starting,
I knew very little about programming – now I can write functions, work with
arrays of objects, and use Git to manage my code.

## Skills (so far)

- HTML & CSS basics
- JavaScript fundamentals (variables, control flow, loops, functions)
- JavaScript data structures (arrays, objects, map/filter/reduce)
- Git & GitHub workflow

## Goals

By the end of the bootcamp, I want to:

- Pick a track and build comfort in a real-world stack
- Ship at least 4 portfolio-worthy projects
- Be ready to apply for junior developer roles

## Hobbies

(Add a few sentences about what you like outside of coding.)
EOF

# Commit it
git add profile.md
git commit -m "Add personal profile page"

# Push the feature branch (NOT main) to GitHub
git push -u origin add-profile
```

---

## Step 4: Open a Pull Request

1. Go to your GitHub repo — you should see a yellow banner: **“add-profile had recent pushes — Compare & pull request”**
2. Click it

3. Fill in:

- **Title:** “Add personal profile page”
- **Description:**

```
## What
Adds profile.md with a short personal introduction.

## Why
Gives visitors a quick way to learn about the author when they land on the repo.

## How to test
Visit profile.md on the repo – should render as a normal Markdown page.
```

4. Click **“Create pull request”**
  5. On the PR page, scroll down and click **“Merge pull request”** → **“Confirm merge”**
  6. Click **“Delete branch”** to clean up
- 

## Step 5: Sync Locally

```
# Get the merged main
git checkout main
git pull

# Delete the feature branch locally too – it's merged
git branch -d add-profile

# Verify final state
git log --oneline
# You should see at least 3 commits including the merge
```

---

## Final Check

Open your GitHub repo and confirm:

- ☐ `README.md`, `.gitignore`, `index.md`, and `profile.md` all visible on `main`
  - ☐ The README renders nicely with headings and a table
  - ☐ The merged PR appears in the “Pull requests” tab (filter: Closed)
  - ☐ The `add-profile` branch is deleted on GitHub
  - ☐ Your contribution graph for today shows green squares
-

## Stretch Goals

If you finish early:

1. **Pin the repo to your GitHub profile.** Go to your profile → “Customize your pins” → select **dev-portfolio**. This makes it the first thing visitors see.
  2. **Add a banner image to your README.** Use a free tool like [banner.godori.dev](https://banner.godori.dev) or design one in Canva, save it as **banner.png**, push it, then add `![Banner](./banner.png)` at the top of your README.
  3. **Enable GitHub Pages.** Repo → Settings → Pages → Source: “Deploy from a branch” → Branch: **main / (root)** → Save. Wait a minute, then visit <https://your-username.github.io/dev-portfolio/> — your README is now a live website.
  4. **Add a **projects/** folder** with a placeholder file for each upcoming bootcamp project. As you build each one, you'll commit the code there.
  5. **Add a **LICENSE** file.** Click “Add file” → “Create new file” on GitHub → name it **LICENSE** → click the “Choose a license template” link → pick MIT (the most permissive). Commit it directly through the GitHub UI to practice the web flow too.
- 

## How to Submit

1. The link to your live repo: <https://github.com/your-username/dev-portfolio>
2. A screenshot of the merged Pull Request
3. A screenshot of your `git log --oneline` showing the final state

Upload to Google Classroom.

**Bonus:** Post your repo link in the WhatsApp group and visit at least three classmates' portfolios. Star the ones you like.